

Burak Kalafat

Senior Backend Engineer | .NET | Banking & Payments

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Istanbul, Turkey | Europe/Istanbul

SUMMARY

Hands-on software engineer with 14+ years in banking, payments and enterprise financial software. Modernises COBOL/mainframe systems into .NET and Java backends, including EOD and batch workloads. Combines implementation, architecture decisions and technical leadership with enterprise Copilot engineering and reusable AI-assisted development workflows. International remote experience; targeting UK/EU relocation and EMEA remote opportunities, including visa-sponsored roles.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Banking and Modernisation: Payment systems, COBOL/mainframe modernisation, End-of-Day (EOD), Batch processing, Job dependencies, Workload orchestration

Backend Engineering: C#, .NET, .NET Core, ASP.NET MVC, REST APIs, EF Core, Asynchronous programming, WCF

Architecture and Design: Clean Architecture, Domain-Driven Design (DDD), Distributed systems, Service-oriented architecture, Repository, Unit of Work, Facade, Strategy

Data and Integration: Oracle, SQL Server (MSSQL), PL/SQL, IBM MQ, RabbitMQ

Enterprise AI Engineering: GitHub Copilot Enterprise, AI-assisted SDLC, Agentic development, Spec-Driven Development (SDD), Developer enablement, Architecture enablement

Delivery and Platforms: Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, Docker, Kubernetes

Technical Leadership and Quality: Architecture guidance, Code reviews, Mentoring, Coding standards, Unit testing, Playwright E2E testing

Languages and Frameworks: Java, Spring, TypeScript, JavaScript, WPF, WinForms, Knockout.js

Training: Microservices, .NET with AWS, React

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer (Backend, .NET) | Innovance

May 2024 – Present | Istanbul, Turkey (Remote)

- Modernise Akbank payment and banking systems from COBOL/mainframe to C#/.NET and Java, analysing legacy business rules and making backend architecture decisions.
- Work on mission-critical EOD and batch modernisation, analysing job dependencies and workload orchestration for scheduled banking processes.
- Designed and developed an enterprise GitHub Copilot plugin for the Architecture organisation, packaging reusable guidance, agent/sub-agent workflows and engineering standards.
- Built repository- and database-oriented Copilot workflows and reusable engineering knowledge to support AI-assisted SDLC and spec-driven development across teams.
- Built internet and mobile banking backends for Türkiye Finans using ASP.NET MVC, WCF, SQL Server and unit tests.

Senior Software Engineer (Backend, .NET) | insightsoftware

September 2022 – April 2024 | North Carolina, USA (Remote)

- Developed C#/.NET Core backend features for enterprise financial software, contributing to architecture and technical design.
- Collaborated with an international remote engineering team on backend design and delivery.

Senior Software Engineer (Backend, .NET) | OBSS

September 2017 – September 2022 | Istanbul, Turkey

- Led Halkbank mobile banking backend migration from .NET Framework to .NET Core and Clean Architecture.
- Applied asynchronous programming and thread optimisation to banking request handling; built REST APIs with EF Core and SQL Server.
- Used Repository/Unit of Work patterns and Azure DevOps CI/CD pipelines for backend delivery.
- Owned code reviews and mentored Türkiye Finans developers, establishing coding standards for WinForms and WCF applications.
- Led Akbank payment campaign development with C#, Java/Spring, TypeScript, Knockout.js and Oracle 12c.

Java Developer | TÜBİTAK

January 2017 – September 2017 | Kocaeli, Turkey

- Built Java software to write EAC/SAC security data to passport smartcard chips using APDU commands for government identification systems.

.NET Developer | VakıfBank

August 2013 – January 2017 | Istanbul, Turkey

- Modernised VakıfBank CRM and collections applications towards service-oriented architecture with WPF/MVVM, WCF, Oracle 11g and PL/SQL.

Part-Time .NET Developer | VeriPark

December 2012 – June 2013 | Izmir, Turkey

- Built ASP.NET widgets for Turkcell's SharePoint environment while completing the Computer Engineering degree.

EDUCATION

BSc in Computer Engineering

Ege University, Izmir, Turkey | September 2008 – June 2013

CERTIFICATIONS

Microsoft Certified: Azure AI Engineer Associate

Microsoft | Certification | March 6, 2026 | Expires March 6, 2027 | Certification overview (AI-102)

Introduction to GitHub Copilot

Microsoft Learn | Training | 2024 | Course overview

Build Microservices with .NET and Amazon Web Services

Udemy | Training | February 2024

IELTS - Band 7

British Council | Language test | 2023

React Nanodegree Program

Udacity | Training | February 2020

LANGUAGES

Turkish: Native; English: Professional proficiency; IELTS Band 7 (2023)

INTERESTS

Chess; LLM and RAG applications; AI-powered customer service; Travel and cultural exchange